Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff AI Product Engineer | AI Developer Tools & Commerce Platforms

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with 20 years of experience building developer platforms, commerce products, and frontend systems. Combines deep TypeScript/React architecture with hands-on applied AI engineering, including multimodal generation, agent orchestration, human-in-the-loop workflows, and evaluation-driven development. Known for turning experimental ideas into extensible tools and for leading technically complex work while mentoring other engineers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & agents: Vercel AI SDK, Pi (RPC/extensions), MCP, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, multimodal generation, agent orchestration, evaluation and validation workflows

Product & frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Remix, CSS Modules, frontend architecture, API design, developer experience

Backend & infrastructure: Node.js, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Docker, Kubernetes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–2026

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an internal multimodal AI platform first started by another person, as an isomorphic TypeScript library built on Vercel AI SDK with web, CLI, and MCP interfaces; built a model registry, asynchronous workflows, provider fallbacks, and long-running job polling. The platform generated **100,000+ images** and served an estimated **hundreds of daily users**.
- Designed an AI-assisted migration prototype for customized Liquid email templates, reaching **90% success on a small curated benchmark** through structure-aware code changes, rendering checks, vision-model comparison, and human review; subsequently served as technical lead for **six engineers** during production development. Initiative was canceled before launch.
- Built an end-to-end multi-agent code-review workflow with low-cost change classification, dynamically selected specialist reviewers, aggregated feedback, guided PR tours, and generated diagrams; piloted with a handful of engineers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- Built Pi coding-agent tooling, including low-latency multi-model safety evaluation with human override, web-to-Markdown retrieval, rich editing, and extensible interaction surfaces for Pi IDE.
- Extended Shopify's UI extension architecture to the Admin product-detail page, implementing the initial **Bundles** card; contributed to bundles in checkout and Shopify's first-party Admin application while mentoring junior engineers and an intern.
- Developed product-field coverage calculations and rule-inheritance visualizations for channel-specific product mappings; prototyped bulk-editing improvements for the multichannel commerce product launched in late 2026.

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped the developer-facing API for Shopify Checkout UI Extensions, collaborating with a Principal Engineer on integration with sandboxed remote UI; foundational concepts were retained in the production platform.
- Helped bring native B2B commerce capabilities into Shopify following the Handshake acquisition, including business customer and payment terms initiatives.
- Contributed to Shopify's first-party post-checkout upsell system; named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658 (granted 2022).

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Software Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Helped modernize a multi-tenant B2B commerce product as one of a small frontend engineering team, including a migration toward React and development of self-service wholesale ordering and customizable catalogs.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Built core frontend libraries, asset-management and build tooling, cart experiences, and multiple checkout generations for a major ecommerce platform; contributed to responsive design adoption and mentored engineers.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Web Developer, Mindspark Interactive Networks (2008–2009); Developer, Tyler Technologies (2006–2008); Research Assistant, University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science